



Delaware County Commissioners Meeting January 24th 2022

Meeting Metadata	Details
Video Recording	https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=3_HNiyI1Wug
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Delaware County Commissioners Meeting Report

Meeting Date: January 24, 2022

Convened Time: 9:02 AM

1. Meeting Identification & Attendance

- **Call to Order & Spoken Details:** The meeting was called to order at 9:02 AM by the presiding officer. Opening procedures included the Pledge of Allegiance.
- **Attendance:**
 - **Present:** Mr. King, Mr. Henry, Mr. Brook, and Ms. Riggins (participating via Zoom; requested the presiding officer to run the meeting).
 - **Absent:** None explicitly noted.
 - **Presiding Officer:** Noted as presiding by request of Ms. Riggins.

2. Preliminary & Procedural Business

- **Ceremonial Openings:** The meeting opened with the Pledge of Allegiance.
- **Approval of Minutes:**

- **Action & Vote Disposition:** Approved by Voice Vote / Roll Call following a motion and second for the January 3, 2022 regular meeting minutes and the January 7, 2022 special meeting minutes.
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3. Substantive Business & Board Action

Appointments

- **ECI Regional Planning District Appointments 00:01:07**
 - **Sponsor / Presenter:** Board / Presiding Officer
 - **Deliberation Summary:** Motion to reappoint James King, Ryan Ballard, and Martin Moody.
 - **Action & Vote Disposition:** Passed Unanimously (Roll call: Mr. King, yes; Ms. Reagan, yes; Mr. Henry, yes).
- **Board of Health Appointments 00:01:38**
 - **Sponsor / Presenter:** Board / Presiding Officer
 - **Deliberation Summary:** Consideration to appoint Dr. John Peterson and Vicki Mitchell to the Board of Health.
 - **Action & Vote Disposition:** Passed Unanimously (Roll call: Ms. Reagan, yes; Mr. King, yes; Mr. Henry, yes).
- **Fair Board Appointment 00:02:08**
 - **Sponsor / Presenter:** Board / Presiding Officer
 - **Deliberation Summary:** Request to place Dan White back on the Fair Board to fill a vacancy. Melanie Marshall later spoke in support 00:09:08, noting the Fair Board is now at full complement.
 - **Action & Vote Disposition:** Passed Unanimously (Roll call: Mr. King, yes; Ms. Reagan, yes; Mr. Henry, yes).
- **Plan Commission Appointment 00:02:31**
 - **Sponsor / Presenter:** Ms. Moody / Board
 - **Deliberation Summary:** Motion to allow Ricky Sipe to remain on the Plan Commission following term expiration clarification.
 - **Action & Vote Disposition:** Passed Unanimously (Roll call: Ms. Reagan, yes; Mr. King, yes; Mr. Henry, yes).

Presentations

- **Engineering Firm Introduction 00:03:38**
 - **Sponsor / Presenter:** Dan Watson, Beam, Longest & Neff Engineering Firm
 - **Deliberation Summary:** Dan Watson introduced his family-owned engineering firm headquartered in Castleton, Indiana, highlighting their full range of services (roads,

bridges, right-of-way, environmental) and requesting consideration for future Delaware County infrastructure projects.

Contracts, Grants & Resolutions

- **00:05:25 Delaware County Health Department Workforce Development Grant**
 - **Sponsor / Presenter:** Jamie Bain, Health Department Administrator
 - **Deliberation Summary:** Seeking permission to apply for a new COVID-related workforce development co-ag grant from the state health department under the grants ordinance.
 - **Action & Vote Disposition:** Passed Unanimously (Roll call: Mr. King, yes; Ms. Reagan, yes; Mr. Henry, yes).
- **00:06:28 High-Tech Crime Unit Interlocal Agreement & Resolution 2022-02**
 - **Sponsor / Presenter:** Eric Hoffman, Prosecuting Attorney / Don (Legal Counsel)
 - **Deliberation Summary:** Prosecutor Hoffman discussed the state-awarded high-tech crimes unit funding. The interlocal agreement assigns a full-time sergeant from the Muncie Police Department investigations division to the prosecutor's office, with the county paying the city \$50,000.
 - **Action & Vote Disposition:**
 - *Interlocal Agreement:* Approved by Voice Vote / Roll Call (Roll call: Ms. Reagan, yes; Mr. King, yes; Mr. Henry, yes).
 - *Resolution 2022-02 (Approving Agreement):* Approved by Voice Vote / Roll Call (Roll call: Mr. King, yes; Ms. Reagan, yes; Mr. Henry, yes).
- **00:12:09 Resolution 2022-003: Solar Farm Application Moratorium Confirmation**
 - **Sponsor / Presenter:** Don (Legal Counsel) / Marta Moody (Plan Commission)
 - **Deliberation Summary:** Formal written confirmation (Resolution 2022-003) of the board's prior motion establishing a moratorium on the introduction and filing of solar farm applications with the Plan Commission. Effective from January 3 until February 22. Marta Moody announced a Plan Commission public meeting scheduled for February 3 at 6:00 PM at the Justice Center (3100 South Tillotson Avenue).
 - **Action & Vote Disposition:** Passed Unanimously (Roll call: Ms. Reagan, yes; Mr. King, yes; Mr. Henry, yes).

Financial & Department Reports

- **00:09:42 Plan Commission Building Permit Report:** Marta Moody distributed a three-year comparative report showing permit counts grew from 480 (2019) to 787 (2020) and 858 (2021), with revenues increasing from over \$60,000 to \$342,082.41.
- **00:11:23 Auditor's Office Introduction:** Auditor introduced Marshall Morgan, a Ball State political science major interning in the auditor's office.
- **00:13:58 Weights and Measures Report:** Received and acknowledged by the board.
- **00:14:03 Payment of Claims:**

- **Details:** Claims presented totaling \$1,693,993.35.
 - **Action & Vote Disposition:** Approved by Voice Vote / Roll Call (Roll call: Mr. King, yes; Ms. Reagan, yes; Mr. Henry, yes).
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4. Open Public Comment / Citizen Forum

- **00:15:06 Kathy Curtly:** Spoke as a concerned resident of the Gaston area regarding potential solar panel installations. Expressed concerns over farmland loss, predictable negative/inefficient outcomes, lack of long-term safe technology, and impacts on future generations of farmers.
 - **00:18:19 Cole Stevens:** Spoke in support of solar panels, noting his family signed their land up for the project. Emphasized the need for open dialogue, reliable power generation sources as coal plants shut down, and economic benefits to landowners, local government, and schools.
 - **[00:17:00 / 00:21:17] Jackie Sheets:** Raised serious safety concerns regarding potential solar panel fires and the adequacy of a 100-foot setback (requesting a larger setback matching Grant County's 1,320 feet). Also expressed concern regarding toxic disposal and recycling challenges for damaged panels.
 - **00:23:20 Tom Schroeder:** Representing Energy regarding the proposed Meadowforge solar project. Assured residents that the company is available to answer questions, highlighted project steps (road use, decommissioning, economic development agreements), and noted engineering safety measures, 250-foot residential setbacks, 140 mph wind-resistant technology, and local economic tax benefits.
 - **00:26:18 Kelly Watson:** Neutral speaker who inquired whether the project would prioritize local county workforce residents.
 - **00:26:50 Tim Nickim:** Supported previous comments against large-scale solar. Noted hundreds of community concerns regarding property values, visual landscape disruption from horizon to horizon, and requested stronger ordinance protections and adherence to traditional variance procedures rather than making solar an accepted use on farmland.
 - **00:29:44 David Mock:** Expressed frustration that no local commissioners, council members, or planning/zoning commissioners attended a very informative community meeting held in Westdale on the prior Saturday. Urged the board to deeply study the negatives.
 - **00:31:12 Susan Dillon:** Spoke regarding the community division caused by the solar project rollout. Highlighted a potential solution offered at the Saturday meeting: requiring individual variances for each solar project to foster dialogue, compromise, and community unity.
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5. Administrative Updates & Adjournment

- **Staff / Board Announcements:** Plan Commission meeting set for February 3, 2022, at 6:00 PM at the Justice Center.
 - **Adjournment:** The meeting moved into recess 00:32:56. (Exact final adjournment time not explicitly recorded before transcript cutoff).
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